



MESSIAH OF MUSIC ASTRIDE THE GLOBE

**Sri Ganapati Sachchidananda Swamiji,
Avadhoota Datta Peetham, Mysore**

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A BEACON of spiritual light, a healer of body and mind and a sage in the true sense is known the world over today as His Holiness Sri Ganapati Sachchidananda Swamiji. Sixty-five years ago, he was a mere infant born in a scholarly Brahmin family at the tiny village of Mekedatu, close to the confluence of the sacred Kaveri River and the Arkavathi in Kanakapura taluk, Karnataka.

The boy, born on 26 May 1942, was given the name of Satyanarayana. Like all children around that time, boy Satyanarayana was also admitted in school but his mind wandered. He felt more at home in the lap of Nature, paying keen attention to different notes of sound in natural surroundings. This was a pointer to the importance that sound was to assume in his later life.

If Nature was one book of wonder to learn from, his mother Matha Jayalakshmi, a disciple of Karapatra Yateendra Yogi and Fakir Thaatha, a Sufi mystic, was his spiritual mentor. The profound Avadhoota tradition in the household of his father Gandluru Narasimha Shastri gave the boy constant exposure to Vedic learning.

As the boy grew up, he drifted away from formal education and plunged deeper and deeper into spiritual quest. Simultaneously, his fascination for the sounds of nature also evolved into keen interest in the intricacies of classical music and musical instruments.

All this equipped and enabled him to set up an ashram in Mysore in June 1966, when he was barely 24, in the prime of youth. The intensity of his pursuit of the mystic aspect of life, his stature as a spiritual leader and the volume of his followers grew rapidly and soon the ashram expanded into the awesome Avadhoota Datta Peetham that we see today.

In the 40 years since then, Sri Swamiji's achievements in the spiritual realm have resulted in scores of devotees and followers find peace of mind and harmonious existence. Poojya Ganapati Sachchidananda Swamiji has set up 70 centres in the country and abroad to spread his message of spiritualism and music therapy for physical and mental ailments. For this purpose, he has traveled abroad countless times. These centres propagate Sri Swamiji's message of *Kriya Yoga & Nada Chikitsa* or healing by music and meditation and promote numerous social service projects. The centres in Trinidad, West Indies has consecrated a 65 ft. statue of Hanuman, and a temple complex reflecting the various architectural traditions of

India. Audio Albums of Poojya Swamiji's divine and healing music performed live are available all over the world. A Swiss devotee who is a reputed architect has installed telephone booths all over Switzerland where people hear Sri Swamiji's soothing music as soon as they enter. Other followers vouch for the Swamiji's prophetic utterances that have come true in their life.

All of them along with thousands of others view Poojya Swamiji as the embodiment of divinity. Such perception arises not only from Sri Swamiji's mission of healing and universal well-being, but all from his overall compassionate personality. His Holiness Sri Ganapati Sachchidananda Swamiji thus is truly a spiritual leader with a scientific outlook, and a sage that anyone would salute in reverence.

BOOKS & RECORDINGS

Pujya Sri Swamiji has given discourses on Datta Charita, Guru Gita, Nava Durga Charita, Subramanya Charita, Ramayana, Bhagavata, Ashthadasha Shakti Peethas, Dwadasha Jyoti Lingas, Ganapati Tattva, Hanuman Charita, Atma Vilasa, Avadhoota Gita, Upanishads, Vedanta Lessons and many more in Telugu, Kannada, Tamil, Hindi and English languages. Audio CD's, DVDs, MP3 CDs and VCDs of Pujya Sri Swamiji's Meditation & Healing Music, Divya Nama Sankirtana (Bhajans) and discourses are available in the Ashrama book store along with numerous books in various languages.

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Albums are also available at Apple i Tunes store.
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